

Sana S. Burney

VISUAL ARTIST | ART EDUCATOR | RESEARCHER

Karachi, Pakistan / Lancashire, UK • sanaburney.sb@gmail.com • www.sanaburney.com

PROFILE

Sana S. Burney is a visual artist and art educator originally from Karachi, Pakistan, and currently based in Lancashire, UK. Her interdisciplinary practice explores colonial and postcolonial histories, identity, belonging, displacement, cultural memory, and the ways visual narratives move between places.

Working across analogue and digital collage, photography, mixed media, pattern, public art and site-responsive practice, Burney is particularly interested in how histories, cultural narratives and social structures shape individual and collective identities. Her experience of working within Karachi's urban environment has contributed significantly to her ongoing interest in public space, place, cultural hybridity and the relationship between art and everyday audiences.

SELECTED EXHIBITIONS & ARTISTIC PROJECTS

2025 London Art Biennale - London, UK

2023 In The Crossfire - Online group exhibition, SEAS - Socially Engaged Art Salon, Brighton, UK

2023 Cut, Torn and Mended - Group exhibition and zine publication, Spilt Milk, Scotland, UK

2021 Learning in-and-within Relation (after Edouard Glissant) - Mural project with Jade Montserrat, Hanover Project, University of Central Lancashire, UK

2021 Interim Show - MA Fine Art online exhibition, University of Central Lancashire, UK

2021 Harris Open - Harris Museum & Art Gallery, Preston, UK

2017 Sugarcoated - Group exhibition of Pakistani artists, Hoxton Basement, London, UK

2017 Creative Crosswalks - Participatory public-art project with Foundation Programme students, Indus Valley School of Art and Architecture, Karachi, Pakistan

2017 Reel on Hai - Artist contribution; developed and launched two reels for Karachi Biennale, Karachi, Pakistan

2016 FTC Flyover Beautification Project - Project Head and Artist, public-art intervention commissioned by the Government of Sindh, Karachi, Pakistan

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS & RESEARCH

2023 Cut, Torn and Mended - Artworks published in accompanying zine, Spilt Milk, Scotland, UK

2023 Tension - Artist book, SU4IP, UK

2021 Patterns of Pakistan - Artist publication comprising 46 pattern designs inspired by tessellation and the decorative visual languages of Pakistan

2021 Public Art: From Karachi Biennale to the Killing Fields of Karachi - DCA Conference, Kennesaw State University, Atlanta, USA

2018 Public Art: An Evolution from Traditional Enclosure to Contemporary Invasion - DCA Conference, Cornell University, Ithaca, New York, USA

2018 Bridging the Gap, Filling in the Void: Public Art in Diverse Communities - AMPS Conference, Altinbas University, Istanbul, Turkey

2017 The Possible Propagandistic Desires behind Public Art in Karachi - THAAP Conference, Lahore, Pakistan

2016 The Emergence of Truck Art Boom as Karachi Pop in Response to the War on Terror - DCA Conference, Ozyegin University, Istanbul, Turkey

EDUCATION

2025 PGCert Higher Education (Global), Distinction - University of Nottingham, UK

2021 MA Fine Art, Merit - University of Central Lancashire, UK

2013 Postgraduate Diploma in Photography - Indus Valley School of Art and Architecture, Karachi, Pakistan

2008 BA Fine Art - Department of Visual Studies, University of Karachi, Karachi, Pakistan

SELECTED ACADEMIC & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2009-2023 Assistant Professor / Course Leader, Basic Design Foundation Programme - Indus Valley School of Art and Architecture, Karachi, Pakistan

Over 15 years of experience in art and design education, including studio teaching, curriculum development, mentorship, course leadership and interdisciplinary foundation education.

2014-2016 Adjunct Faculty, Department of Visual Studies - University of Karachi, Karachi, Pakistan

2014-2015 Adjunct Faculty, Media Sciences - Iqra University, Karachi, Pakistan

2023 Freelance Photography Instructor - Orble, Preston, UK

SELECTED LEADERSHIP & PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

- Course Leader, Basic Design Foundation Programme, Indus Valley School of Art and Architecture, Karachi
- Project Head and Artist, FTC Flyover Beautification Project, Karachi
- Participatory project lead, Creative Crosswalks, Karachi

SPECIALISMS

Analogue & Digital Collage · Mixed-Media Assemblage · Photography · Pattern & Visual Language · Site-Responsive Art · Public Art · Participatory Practice

ARTIST STATEMENT

My practice explores colonial and postcolonial histories, racialised inequality, belonging and displacement, feminism, capitalism and the complexities of hybrid identity. I am interested in how histories, social structures and cultural narratives shape individual and collective identities and influence our relationships with place.

My work often begins with found or existing images, objects, archives and histories, which I recontextualise through collage, assemblage, photography and mixed-media processes. Layering, fragmentation and juxtaposition allow different times, geographies and perspectives to coexist within a work, exposing tensions beneath familiar representations and established narratives.

My experience of working in public and site-responsive contexts in Karachi has also shaped my understanding of how art can engage with architecture, urban space, memory and everyday audiences.

As my practice continues to evolve, I am increasingly interested in image, pattern, repetition, movement and illumination as ways of exploring how histories, memories, identities and cultural knowledge travel between places. Living and working between Pakistan and the UK has further developed my interest in translation, cultural hybridity and the shifting meanings that images and visual traditions acquire when they move across geographical and cultural contexts.